

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior SOC Detection Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Operations Centre (SOC) Detection Engineer with over five years of experience developing, testing and deploying detection content across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM platforms. I specialise in writing and optimising detection logic using Kusto Query Language (KQL), building analytics rules mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and driving continuous improvement of the detection content lifecycle in live SOC environments. I have also worked with Splunk and Search Processing Language (SPL)-based detection logic. My background spans building a hybrid SOC from the ground up, leading threat hunting activities and serving as the senior escalation lead for complex security incidents. I am eligible for Security Check (SC) clearance and am excited to bring my detection engineering expertise to a high-impact national security environment. I am seeking a hybrid permanent role where I can make a direct and measurable contribution to the organisation's threat detection capability.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Detection Engineering (Primary Focus):** Full detection content lifecycle — design, development, testing, deployment, tuning and documentation
- **Microsoft Sentinel:** Workspace design, data connector configuration, **KQL analytics rules**, automation playbooks (Logic Apps), workbooks, scheduled alert rules
- **Kusto Query Language (KQL — Strong):** Writing and optimising detection logic, threat hunting queries and operational dashboards
- **Splunk / SPL:** Detection query development and log analysis using Search Processing Language (SPL)
- **CrowdStrike Falcon (Expert):** NG-SIEM, EDR, Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover — detection rule management, alert triage and tuning
- **SIEM Engineering and SOAR:** Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development; correlation rule tuning; alert noise reduction
- **MITRE ATT&CK:** Technique-mapped detection development, gap analysis and threat-informed defence
- **Threat Hunting:** Intelligence-led hypothesis-driven hunting using KQL across Sentinel and CrowdStrike
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61; senior escalation lead; complex investigation ownership
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender — XDR telemetry integration
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell; KQL automation; Logic Apps
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Leads the **detection engineering function** within a hybrid SOC, owning the full detection content lifecycle across **Microsoft Sentinel** and **CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM**
- Develops, tests and deploys **KQL analytics rules** in Microsoft Sentinel, including scheduled alert rules, multi-stage attack detection and entity behaviour analytics, mapped to MITRE ATT&CK techniques
- Writes and optimises detection logic using **KQL** and **Splunk SPL**; continuously tunes rules to reduce false positives and sharpen signal quality
- Configures and maintains **Microsoft Sentinel data connectors** across Microsoft 365, Azure, CrowdStrike, Mimecast and other sources, ensuring comprehensive log ingestion for detection coverage

- Builds **Logic Apps-based SOAR automation playbooks** to automate alert enrichment, containment actions and analyst notification, reducing response time and analyst toil
- Conducts **intelligence-led threat hunting** using MITRE ATT&CK-mapped KQL queries across Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight; documents findings and converts confirmed hunts to production detection rules
- Serves as the **senior incident response escalation lead**, owning complex investigations from detection through to post-incident review
- Performs SIEM and detection content gap analysis; produces a prioritised detection improvement roadmap aligned to current threat intelligence
- Manages vulnerability management programme using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io and AppCheck; uses findings to inform and validate detection coverage

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Contributed to the initial build of the **Microsoft Sentinel** deployment, configuring data connectors and authoring foundational KQL detection rules for the SOC
- Operated **CrowdStrike Falcon EDR** across the endpoint estate, triaging alerts, tuning prevention policies and conducting threat investigations
- Deployed and integrated **Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)** and **Defender for Identity (MDI)** into the SOC for 8,000 users, providing XDR-level telemetry for enriched detection
- Triaged SIEM and EDR alerts, escalated complex incidents and contributed to playbook development within a structured SOC framework
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory/Azure AD), Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO), reducing identity-based attack surface
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Nessus and AppCheck; used findings to validate and improve detection coverage for known CVEs

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Monitored security events and supported log analysis activities in a SaaS/FinTech environment
- Developed PowerShell scripts for automation of security and infrastructure workflows
- Supported vulnerability assessment, penetration test finding remediation and ISO 27001 compliance activities

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built the **detection engineering capability from the ground up** within a hybrid SOC, establishing a structured content development pipeline across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM
- Authored and deployed **KQL analytics rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK** that improved detection coverage and reduced mean time to detect across multiple threat categories
- Converted **threat hunting findings into production detection rules**, systematically closing detection gaps identified through intelligence-led hunting activity
- Built a **SOAR automation playbook library** in Logic Apps that automated alert enrichment and containment actions, cutting mean time to respond for high-severity incidents
- Performed a structured **detection content gap analysis** using MITRE ATT&CK, producing a prioritised roadmap that guided detection improvement investment over 12 months

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+

- Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)